

NVIDIA Laptops – Shrinking size, not performance

NVIDIA brought out something for everyone at COMPUTEX 2022. This included laptop gamers and creators too. The new gaming laptops showcased at the event were equipped with RTX 3080 Ti, RTX 3080 or RTX 3070 Ti GPUs. The laptops presented were the MSI Raider GE 67 HX, Gigabyte Aorus 17X, and the Asus ROG Flow X16. NVIDIA claimed that complementing these GPUs would be equally powerful CPUs and faster RAM and SSDs.

The Studio laptops, catered to serve the creative and the profes-



Source: NVIDIA

sional sections of their consumer base, were also announced. The common thread tying these laptops is that each is decked out with powerful GPUs and great screens. The three main laptops that NVIDIA

highlighted during this launch were the ASUS Zenbook Pro 16X, Acer ConceptD 5, and Lenovo Yoga Slim 7i ProX.

NVIDIA also announced the Studio driver update for the existing owners of

NVIDIA GPU equipped machines. With this update, the company promised that its RTX cards would see a 30 per cent increase in their performance and other creator-focused features.

SteelSeries Arctis Nova Pro – The best?

There was another blessing in store for gamers. This one was from SteelSeries, as they announced their new Arctis Nova Pro Wireless headset. With its support for simultaneous Bluetooth and 2.4 GHz connections and a completely retractable microphone being a key feature of its design, everyone's hopes soared high.



Source: SteelSeries

SteelSeries announced other features including AI-powered ClearCast Gen 2 noise-cancelling technology and hot-swappable batteries. These swappable batteries would make the headset technically last for an unlimited period of time. The headphone are supported on PC and PlayStation, so you don't have to buy two pairs of headsets for both devices.

ZOTAC Mini PCs – Rockets in a box

ZOTAC's focus during the event was all centred on their miniature PC systems, as they announced a couple of Mini PCs and a wearable VR PC. The ZOTAC VR GO 4.0 looks promising with an Intel Core i7 8-core CPU, NVIDIA RTX A4500 16 GB GPU, and 16 GB of DDR4 memory.

The other two ZOTAC releases were Mini PCs. The ZOTAC ZBOX QTG7A4500, dubbed "the thinnest professional workstation", comes with the same GPU and CPU combo as its backpack cousin. It supports up to 64 GB DDR4-3200/2933 memory, and four display outputs (2x HDMI 2.1 and 2x DisplayPort 1.4a). The other Mini PC announced was the ZBOX PI336 Pico. A much less powerful system as compared to others on the announcements list, the PI336, has an Intel Celeron N6211 dual-core processor and just 4 GB LPDDR4x memory.

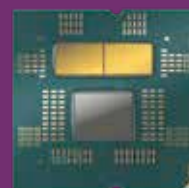


Source: ZOTAC

AMD APUs – Budget segment challengers

AMD has historically been known to make some of the best APUs for budget machines. At COMPUTEX, they presented a new chip codenamed "Mendocino" to the world. This APU is supposed to target the budget laptop section falling in the \$399 to

\$699 price range. That is also reflected in its



Source: AMD

specifications. This new APU has just 4x 'Zen 2' cores and RDNA 2 graphics. That should be enough for it to be put into a Chromebook or a lightweight Windows machine. While the company made the numbers for the CPU core count public, the exact specification of its RDNA 2 integrated graphics is still under wraps.